

Meta title: How to Replace or Change Your Pool Light | Baracuda

Meta description: Learn how to change a pool light safely, when to replace the bulb or fixture, and when to call a pool professional. Read more on Baracuda

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Step By Step Guide: How to Replace or Change Your Pool Light

A faulty pool light can make night swimming less enjoyable and, in some cases, point to a larger issue with the light fixture, gasket, or wiring.

This step-by-step guide explains how to change a pool light, what pool owners need to check before starting, and where the job can go wrong. In many cases, a pool light can be removed from the pool wall without draining the swimming pool. Yet that does not mean every pool owner should do the job themselves. If there is any doubt around electricity, water seepage, the light housing, or the entire fixture, it is safer to stop and get help.

If you would rather have a pool professional handle the process, use our interactive map to [find a pool store near you](#).

Key takeaways

- Many pool light jobs can be done without draining the pool, yet safety comes first.
- A worn gasket, cracked lens, or damaged light housing can turn a simple bulb replacement into a bigger repair.
- If you are unsure about the fixture, wiring, or seal, [find a pool store near you] using our interactive map.

Before you start: safety tips and checks for pool owners

Before you touch the pool light fixture, switch off the power at the circuit breaker and double-check that the light does not turn on. Do not rely on the wall switch alone.

Next, check what type of pool light you have:

- Some older lights use a swimming pool light bulb or replacement bulb inside the existing fixture.
- Many newer models use sealed LED pool lights, in which the entire unit is replaced rather than just the bulb.

Look at the light housing, lens, screw, cord, and gasket. If the lens is cracked, the housing is brittle, the cord is damaged, or there are signs of leaks or water seepage, this may no longer be a simple bulb job.

Set out the right tools before you start. In most cases, that means a screwdriver, a dry towel, and the new light or replacement bulb that matches the brand and model.

If you are not fully confident with the safety side of the job, [find a pool store near you](#) using our interactive map.

Image note: Add a simple safety checklist infographic here.

When should you call a pool professional?

There is a point where replacing a pool light stops being a simple maintenance task.

Call a pool professional if:

- The light fixture will not come free from the pool wall
- The cord, wires, or housing looks damaged
- The fixture fills with water
- The circuit breaker trips after installation
- You are changing from an old light to a new LED pool light, and the fit is not clear
- You do not have the right tools, or you do not feel safe working on the job

For product advice or help with a compatible replacement, [find a pool store near you](#) using our interactive map.

Step 1: Identify whether you need a bulb replacement or a new pool light fixture

Start by working out what actually needs to be replaced.

If your old light has stopped working, the issue may be the bulb, the gasket, the lens seal, or the fixture itself. Some light fixtures are built for bulb replacement. Others, especially many LED-pool models, are sealed units that require a full replacement.

A new LED pool light can bring real benefits. LED lights usually use less electricity, last longer, and can offer colour-changing options that enhance the look of the swimming pool at night. They can also help lower electricity bills compared with older lights that use more power. The [Lumipro +S3](#) is a great option if you are considering an LED pool light.

If you are upgrading rather than doing a like-for-like replacement, check that the new light fixture is compatible with the existing light housing and installation setup.

Image note: Add an infographic showing “replace bulb” versus “replace entire fixture”.

Step 2: Remove the pool light from the pool wall without draining the pool

Most pool lights are designed to be removed from the pool wall without draining the pool.

In many cases, a single screw at the top of the light fixture holds it in place. Once that screw is removed, you can pull the fixture out of the wall niche and bring it onto the pool deck. The extra cord is usually coiled in the light housing or conduit behind the fixture, which gives you enough line to rest the unit on a towel near the pool.

Work gently. Do not force the fixture out of the wall. If the screw is stuck, the ring is corroded, or the cord will not pull free, stop the process. Pulling too hard can damage the housing, conduit, or wires.

This is one of the points where DIY can turn into a bigger repair job. If access is poor or the fixture will not come free cleanly, [find a pool store near you] using our interactive map.

Image note: Add an infographic showing the single screw, pull direction, cord, and towel placement on the pool edge.

Step 3: Open the light fixture and replace the bulb, gasket, or sealed unit

Once the fixture is out of the water, dry the exterior with a towel and lay it flat on a flat surface.

If your model uses a bulb, remove the old bulb and install the replacement bulb that matches the rating and fitting. If you are fitting a new swimming pool light bulb, avoid touching the glass more than needed.

Check the gasket and lens before you close the fixture again. A worn gasket is a common cause of leaks and water inside the light housing. If the gasket looks flattened, cracked, or brittle, replace it rather than trying to reuse it.

If your pool light is a sealed LED unit, this step may require replacing the entire fixture rather than just swapping a bulb. That is common with many newer LED lights.

Before reassembly, make sure the fixture is sealed tightly. The lens, ring, gasket, and body must sit evenly. Air bubbles or signs of a leak after installation can indicate a bad seal.

If the housing is cracked, the wires look worn, or you are not sure the fixture is sealed tightly, stop here and get help.

Image note: Add an infographic showing bulb replacement, gasket inspection, and sealed LED unit replacement.

Step 4: Reinstall the light, test it, and watch for leak signs

Insert the cord back into the niche or housing space neatly, then place the fixture back into the pool wall and secure the screw.

Once the light is back in place, switch the power on and test the new light. Check that the illumination is even and that the switch works as expected.

Then keep an eye on the fixture for a short period after it is back underwater. Look for air bubbles, moisture under the lens, or signs of water seepage. Those can point to a gasket issue or a poor seal.

If the light trips the circuit breaker, flickers, or shows water inside the fixture, switch the power off again. Do not try to fix that blindly. Contact a pool professional instead.

If you want help with LED pool lights, replacement options, or installation advice, [find a pool store near you](#) using our interactive map.

Image note: Add an infographic showing reinstall, power test, and leak check.

Final thoughts on how to change a pool light

A pool light replacement can be simple when the fixture is in good condition, and the job is only a bulb or gasket change. Yet once the housing, seal, or wiring comes into question, the job needs more care.

If you are unsure at any stage, the safer move is to get expert help. To speak to a professional about LED pool lights, a replacement fixture, or installation support, [find a pool store near you using our interactive map.

Frequently asked questions about changing a pool light

Can you change a swimming pool light without draining the pool?

Yes, many pool light models can be removed without draining the swimming pool. The fixture is usually designed with enough cord to pull it onto the deck for service.

Do you need to replace the whole pool light fixture or just the pool light bulb?

That depends on the model. Some older units take a pool light bulb or a swimming pool light bulb. Many LED pool lights are sealed, which means you replace the entire fixture.

Why is the gasket so important?

The gasket helps keep water out of the fixture. If it is worn or damaged, the risk of leaks and fixture failure increases.

Are LED swimming pool lights worth upgrading to?

For many pool owners, yes. LED lights use less power, last longer, and can offer a wider range of colours and effects.

If you are looking for an excellent swimming pool light, check out our [Baracuda Lumipro +S3](#) - a sleek, energy-efficient pool light that provides 8 colour combinations and two lighting sequences.